

Understanding and Evaluating Cross-Functional Sourcing Team Leadership

BY

Robert J. Trent

Robert Trent is an assistant professor of management at Lehigh University. He received his Ph. D degree from Michigan State University. Dr. Trent's current research interests include cross-functional integration and procurement, and materials management-related topics.

IN BRIEF

As firms experience relentless pressure to innovate and improve, many are responding by creating organizational structures that promote cross-functional and cross-boundary communication, coordination, and collaboration. Because most firms studied expect to use teams to support future procurement and sourcing decision making, it is important to understand how to best manage the cross-functional sourcing team process. Unfortunately, researchers who study teams rarely reach the same conclusions about the factors affecting team success. There is one variable, however, that most researchers agree consistently affects team success — the effectiveness of the formal team leader.

The purpose of this article is to examine the critical role that team leaders play and the challenges they face in a cross-functional sourcing team environment. The final section details three assessment scales used to help identify a sourcing team leader's behavioral style and ability to satisfy critical leadership requirements.

INTRODUCTION

There is little question that firms worldwide are experiencing relentless pressure to innovate and improve. Many are responding to this pressure by creating organizational structures designed to promote cross-functional and cross-company communication, coordination, and collaboration. To support this effort, cross-functional sourcing teams have become increasingly important, particularly as firms attempt to develop leading-edge sourcing strategies and practices.¹ While 80 percent of the major U.S. firms surveyed plan to *emphasize* the use of sourcing teams through the remainder of the 1990s, the success of this approach will vary widely from company to company and team to team, even across teams within the same business.²

When executed properly, the cross-functional team approach can bring together the knowledge and resources required for responding to new sourcing demands, something traditional functional structures are often incapable of doing. However, in a classic work 35 years ago, Likert noted that groups and teams can accomplish much that is good, or they can do great harm. There is nothing *implicitly* good or bad, weak or strong, about teams, regardless of where an organization uses them.³



International Journal of Purchasing and Materials Management © Copyright November 1996, by the National Association of Purchasing Management, Inc.

Because most firms expect to use teams to support procurement and sourcing decision making, it is important to understand how to effectively manage the cross-functional sourcing team process. Unfortunately, researchers who study teams rarely reach the same conclusions about the key factors affecting

team success. The study of teams is complex because no two teams or organizations are the same. A factor affecting one team may have little impact on another.

other variables critical to team interaction and performance.⁷ Overall, effective leadership demonstrates a strong and positive relationship to team performance. Highly effective teams have, on average, leaders whom the team members also rate highly. Conversely, lower performing teams have leaders who were rated lower by the members.⁸

Of all variables affecting a team, few exert as strong an influence on team performance as team leadership. This is true because the team leader is in a position to influence so many other variables that affect performance.

Each team is a unique entity displaying its own behavior and nuances. There is one variable, however, that exerts an unusually strong and consistent impact on team success — the effectiveness of the formal team leader.

The purpose of this article is to examine the critical role that team leaders play and the challenges they face in a cross-functional sourcing team environment.⁴ First, the article outlines the important relationship between leadership and other variables critical to the sourcing team process. Second, the specific responsibilities and requirements that sourcing team leaders must satisfy to be effective are discussed. The final section details three assessment scales used to help identify a sourcing team leader's behavioral style and ability to satisfy critical leadership requirements. The use of these scales highlights opportunities for development and growth at the team leader level.

LINKAGE BETWEEN SOURCING TEAM LEADERSHIP AND TEAM SUCCESS

Why should organizations concern themselves with team leadership? Does it really make that much difference? While many variables potentially affect cross-functional team success, the influence of the team leader is particularly important.⁵ The team leader can affect a team's effort, cohesion, goal selection, and goal attainment. Further, only a formal team leader can perform many of the responsibilities associated with team leadership.⁶ For example, the formal team leader almost always serves as the primary link between the team and the rest of the organization. Previous research relating leadership to team performance points out the absolute need for carefully selecting individuals who have the ability to satisfy the requirements and responsibilities of formal sourcing team leadership.

Of all the variables potentially affecting a team, few exert as strong an influence on team performance as team leadership. This is true in part because the team leader is in a position to influence so many other variables that affect performance. An earlier study of sourcing teams identified a direct link between sourcing team leadership and

The direct relationship between leadership and performance, however, is not the only indicator of the importance of the sourcing team leader. A strong relationship also exists between effective leaders and the team's organizational resources. In particular, teams with highly effective leaders indicate they are able to acquire the budget required to support team activities. Likewise, there is a strong relationship between effective leaders and the availability of external resources, notably supplier support and support from personnel outside the team. Ensuring that a team has the necessary resources is an important requirement of the formal leadership position.

There is also a direct relationship between highly-rated leaders and team member effort, as evaluated by external performance raters. Gaining the commitment and involvement of team members is an important prerequisite for team success. Leaders who obtain the commitment and involvement of all members have increased the probability that the team will achieve its performance goals.

Organizations cannot ignore the important influence that team leaders have on so many of the variables that determine a team's level of success. Management must recognize the important relationships, direct and indirect, between team leadership, communication and coordination, effort, performance, and organizational resource availability. With this recognition it becomes imperative to understand exactly what a sourcing team leader must do to be effective.

RESPONSIBILITIES AND REQUIREMENTS OF SOURCING TEAM LEADERS

As defined here, an effective sourcing team leader is one who is capable of satisfying a set of essential operating responsibilities and requirements while *still promoting the creativity, leadership ability, and innovativeness of individual team members.*

Consequently, there is no single role or responsibility of an effective team leader. Rather, team leaders who operate in a demanding, competitive environment must satisfy a variety of responsibilities and requirements to be effective.

Although most organizations recognize the importance of leadership to innovation and team success, the specific practices of effective team leaders are not as well known.⁹ The following discussion outlines the responsibilities and requirements that a sourcing team leader must satisfy to be effective.

These requirements are derived from the following research activities:

1. Discussions and interviews with cross-functional sourcing team members and leaders
2. Integration of the findings of a comprehensive literature search of group and team leadership undertaken to support an earlier study of cross-functional sourcing teams
3. Personal experience and research with organizational work teams, including sourcing teams

Defining sourcing team leadership in terms of formal responsibilities and requirements begins to transform a concept that is inherently vague into one that becomes understandable to those who must assume this demanding role.

Requirement #1: Work with the Team to Establish and Commit to Performance Goals

Sourcing team leaders should work with members *early in a team's life* to reach agreement about a team's performance goals and objectives. Goal setting is a critical activity for several reasons. Developing quantified goals and objectives provides performance metrics against which to evaluate progress. This is valuable when developing team strategies and action plans, reporting progress to an executive steering committee or executive manager, or providing performance feedback to team members. Further, teams that establish performance targets have a higher probability of success compared with teams that do not establish targets. In a study of cross-functional United States Air Force work teams, teams engaging in formal goal setting achieved 75 percent greater group productivity compared with non-goal setting groups.¹⁰

Goal setting is an ideal way to gain individual commitment because members will likely commit to goals they help establish. Clearly stated *team* goals and objectives also reduce the likelihood that members will misunderstand what the team is attempting to achieve. Finally, teams often develop more aggressive goals than do external managers who establish the targets singularly for the team. The team leader must work with the team to develop challenging goals whose accomplishment creates value and brings personal satisfaction and growth to its members.

Requirement #2: Secure Individual Member Involvement and Commitment

Individuals often find themselves "selected," sometimes reluctantly, to be members of cross-functional sourcing teams.¹¹ Figure 1 segments cross-functional sourcing teams by the nature of the team's assignment and the member's personal time commitment. While some progressive firms are creating *full-time* sourcing team assignments, in most cases assignments are still part time. The lower half of this matrix (project or continuous team assignments supported by part-time members) presents a special challenge to sourcing team leaders. It is often difficult to obtain

the commitment of members who have conflicts resulting from other professional responsibilities. When part-time members face time constraints, the leader may have to work with functional or executive management to reach agreement about how much time members can commit to team activities.

A skillful leader takes steps to make sure that each member remains committed and involved with the team. Members who neglect their team responsibilities usually affect team performance because:

1. The negligent member may fail to support important team tasks and timetables.
2. The negligent member places additional, and perhaps unfair, work burdens on other members.
3. The team loses that member's knowledge and contribution.
4. The negligent member may cause team morale to suffer, thereby affecting longer-term performance.

To secure individual involvement, team leaders must work with the team to delegate tasks among members while holding those members accountable. A leader may also share or rotate leadership responsibilities to help develop the leadership abilities of members while securing buy-in to the team process. Gaining member buy-in during the goal-setting process may also promote individual involvement. Finally, a skilled leader knows how to use an organization's performance evaluation and reward system to motivate members. A team of competent individuals will not achieve anything if its members fail to support the team's assignment(s) by not putting forth the required level of effort.

Requirement #3: Manage Internal Team Conflict

One noted researcher has concluded that groups pass through four stages as they mature. One of these stages, "storming," is characterized by

FIGURE 1 SEGMENTING SOURCING TEAMS BY COMMITMENT AND TIMEFRAME

		Timeframe	
		Finite	Continuous
Personal Commitment	Full Time	Move from project to project	Assigned permanently to specific team with evolving or changing responsibilities
	Part Time	• Support a specific team assignment in addition to regular responsibilities • Disband after completion	Ongoing support of team assignments in addition to regular responsibilities

intragroup conflict and emotional response on the part of the members.¹² Given the range of personalities and positions that a typical team represents, intra-team conflict is inevitable as members discuss important points or work toward a consensus decision. During team interaction the leader often faces a challenge when attempting to differentiate between constructive and destructive conflict.

Constructive conflict is usually healthy in a cross-functional team environment. It means that members are challenging one another as they debate points or make decisions based on the merits of an alternative. This type of conflict rarely has a longer-term negative impact on members. Difficulty arises when conflict becomes destructive. When this occurs, the team risks creating factions or damaging relationships

between individual members, perhaps permanently. Leaders must manage intra-team conflict and recognize when it begins to affect a team's ability to function. The leader must also manage any conflict

An organization with a dominating function risks duplicating those functional relationships within its teams. Purchasing risks being labeled as a dominant function within sourcing teams because of the historical nature of the sourcing process.

that occurs between teams or between the team and the external organization.

Requirement #4: Help Maintain Team Focus and Direction

It is common for members to move in different directions or "go off on a tangent" as they pursue team assignments. Effective leaders tactfully steer a team toward its primary goals while still recognizing the initiative and enthusiasm of members. One way that leaders do this is to reconfirm the team's goals and objectives before each meeting. A second way is to develop a meeting agenda for the team to follow. The leader may also work one-on-one with members who consistently diverge from the team's overall direction. Training in the fundamentals of meeting management will support a leader's efforts at maintaining member focus and direction.

Requirement #5: Secure Required Organizational Resources

Access to the right resources is an important predictor of team success. Teams rarely operate as stand-alone entities — they must interact with and draw support from the organization at large. As the primary link between the team and the rest of the organization, the leader must make sure the team has access to the resources required to support team activities.

These resources include:¹³

- task-related information
- tools and equipment
- routine materials and supplies
- budgetary support

- executive management support
- required services and help from others external to the team
- personnel with the right qualifications for team membership
- time availability for personnel to commit to team assignments
- a work environment conducive to team interaction

For cross-functional sourcing teams, critical resources usually involve budgetary support, qualified and prepared team members, services and help from others external to the team, and adequate time to pursue team assignments. One sourcing team from a global electronics company, for example, failed to achieve any significant performance results. Its members, who were located worldwide, did not have an adequate travel budget or time for face-to-face meetings.

Requirement #6: Prevent Team Domination by a Member or a Function

Domination by a member or functional group is a challenging part of the sourcing team process. There are a number of reasons why a team may have a dominating member. Some individuals simply have a strong personality and seek to control the direction of the group. Or, a member may feel that he or she is an expert on a topic and therefore should dominate discussion. It is also possible the member is from a powerful functional group and wants to maintain the same power relationship within the team.

The presence of a dominating member often prevents other members from contributing. As a result, valuable insights may never come forth because the team cannot engage in a free exchange of ideas. The team leader must differentiate between a consistently dominating member and an enthusiastic or very knowledgeable member. When confronting a dominating member (usually away from the team), there is a risk the member will withdraw from the team. The member may no longer contribute if he or she perceives, usually incorrectly, the leader no longer values his or her contribution. A true dominating member presents a special challenge for team leaders.

A dominating *function* can also affect team interaction and performance. An organization with a dominating function risks duplicating those functional relationships within its teams. Purchasing risks being labeled as a dominant function within sourcing teams because of the historical nature of the sourcing process. A dominating function can present a significant challenge to the team leader when well-established behaviors and relationships carry forward to the team.

Requirement #7: Deal With Internal and External Obstacles Confronting the Team

A leader must confront and resolve a host of internal

and external obstacles facing the team. Examples include a performance evaluation system that fails to recognize or reward team effort, functional managers not committed to the cross-functional sourcing team process, or a lack of critical resources. In a dynamic environment, there will always be internal and external obstacles confronting teams. Overcoming these obstacles requires creativity and flexibility on the part of the team leader.

Requirement #8: Coordinate Multiple Tasks and Manage the Status of Team Assignments

Complex projects and tasks require the coordination of multiple activities in terms of time, budget, accountability, and completion status. Team leaders often rely on project scheduling and control techniques such as Gantt charts or PERT/CPM methods to manage team assignments. The effective use of networking tools allows a leader to manage a project as a system of interrelated tasks with timing and budget constraints. A leader's ability to coordinate assignments and activities is critical for meeting performance targets and management expectations. The leader must also be able to convey how a group of tasks form to create interdependencies within the team.

Requirement #9: Clarify and Help Define Each Member's Role

The team leader should work with the members to clarify or define, but not limit, each member's role on the team, including the leader's role. Ideally, members are part of a team because they offer something unique and insightful to the team's task. Role understanding is also important because individual members, through their functional expertise, may assume leadership during different phases of a project or a team's life. For example, a quality engineer may assume a leadership role when the team attempts to improve a supplier's quality performance.

Team leaders should also work with members as they attempt to move away from strict functional perspectives. For example, 3M's Action Teams work to accelerate the transfer of new technology to new products. Within these teams, members formulate their ideas according to their functional specialty, but then contribute those ideas in terms of a broader organizational context. Each member must develop a macro view, share information, and evaluate whether functional viewpoints will enable the team to meet its broader goal.¹⁴

Leaders can also help members assume *informal* roles. A member may be skillful, for example, at playing the role of a "devil's advocate." This individual constructively probes positions and tests the merits of ideas as the team works toward a consensus decision. A leader that helps a member assume this role effectively will have strengthened the team decision-making process. Proper challenges to ideas

and concepts will occur, thereby preventing the team from agreeing too readily on a single position. Informal team roles are as important as formally defined roles.

Requirement #10: Provide Performance Feedback to Members

Previous research has revealed that an important concern of cross-functional sourcing team members involves having only minimal insight into how well the team or its members are performing over time.¹⁵ This relates directly to an absence of collective and individual member performance feedback. The impact of feedback on team performance, however, is powerful. The U.S. Air Force study cited earlier concluded that group-level feedback improved group performance an average of 50 percent as compared with groups not receiving feedback.¹⁶ Feedback allows teams (and individual members) to measure progress toward stated goals and objectives and to modify performance plans as required.

Many organizations are struggling with how to develop a system that evaluates and rewards combined team and individual member performance.

An inability to tell how well a team is performing makes it difficult to provide team-based and individual feedback. Many organizations are struggling with how to develop a system that evaluates and rewards combined team and individual member performance. As a result, a leader may have difficulty providing meaningful and timely feedback. Even when a formal feedback system exists, it can be a challenge to deliver feedback in a way that does not discourage, anger, or make individual members defensive. *Providing feedback* is a skill that most team leaders must develop before they can realize any benefit from the feedback process.

ASSESSING CROSS-FUNCTIONAL SOURCING TEAM LEADERSHIP

How does an organization know how well its sourcing team leaders satisfy the responsibilities and requirements of the leadership position? How can organizations identify individuals who demonstrate the behavior that effective leaders typically demonstrate? The use of statistically valid measurement scales makes it possible to evaluate cross-functional sourcing team leaders. Organizations can use these scales for several purposes:

1. To evaluate team leader strengths and weaknesses
2. To provide feedback regarding improvement opportunities
3. To allow individual leaders, teams, and organizations to take corrective action as required

Two of the scales, those presented in Figures 2 and 3, are factor-analyzed versions of the Leadership Behavior Description Questionnaire (LBDQ)

originally developed at Ohio State University almost 40 years ago.¹⁷ The statistical revision and development of these scales used responses from over 620 team members and team leaders working at 18 firms based in the United States.¹⁸

Extensive testing of the LBDQ reveals two primary dimensions of leadership behavior: *consideration* (relationship-oriented behavior) and *initiating structure* (task-oriented behavior). Items included in the consideration scale relate to behavior that indicates friendship, trust, and respect between the leader and team members. Leaders rated highly on the consideration dimension enjoy working with others, have a positive view of the contributions made by others, and want to be perceived positively by others. Items relating to the initiating structure scale indicate the degree to which the team leader organizes and defines the relationship between himself or herself and the team members. Leaders rated highly on this dimension are usually skilled at securing team resources, defining the role and responsibility of team members, and establishing well-defined methods for achieving the team's task.

Task-oriented behavior is particularly well-suited for teams pursuing assignments with milestones or performance targets, such as supplier development or new product development.¹⁹ Teams with less structured or open-ended assignments often benefit from relationship-oriented leadership. At a minimum, it is important for team leaders to demonstrate a high degree of relationship-oriented behavior simply because this is what

cross-functional interaction requires. As tasks become complex or structured, however, task-oriented leadership becomes increasingly relevant. Within procurement and sourcing, the leader must also have an in-depth understanding of the sourcing process. The leader must have *task-relevant knowledge*.

The original consideration and initiating structure LBDQ scales had 28 and 20 items respectively. The revised factor-analyzed scales, which are more efficient than the original scales, contain 13 and 11 items respectively. Various items from the original LBDQ scale were not applicable to cross-functional teams or failed to load statistically on the expected factor. The final 13-item relationship-oriented behavioral scale has an internal reliability of 0.91 while the 11-item task-oriented behavioral scale has an internal reliability of 0.87.* Both scales also demonstrate a high degree of external consistency. This means that the items within the scale do not correlate highly with individual items in other scales or with other composite scales.

A third scale evaluates how well individual leaders satisfy the responsibilities and requirements of team leadership presented earlier. Figure 4 details the items contained in this scale. This scale also demonstrates a high degree of internal and external consistency.

Team members, not team leaders, evaluate each scale item for leaders with whom they currently have or have had previous experience. Users can evaluate the three scales at the individual item or

*As measured by Cornbach Alpha

FIGURE 2

ASSESSING RELATIONSHIP-ORIENTED LEADERSHIP BEHAVIOR

Please indicate the appropriate response to each of the following items as they apply to the leader of this cross-functional team.

The leader of our team:	Almost Never	Not Usually	Occasionally	Often	Almost Always
1. Expresses appreciation when one of the team members does a good job	1	2	3	4	5
2. Is easy to understand	1	2	3	4	5
3. Rejects suggestions for change	1	2	3	4	5
4. Resists changing ways of doing things	1	2	3	4	5
5. Refuses to explain his or her actions	1	2	3	4	5
6. Acts without consulting the other team members first	1	2	3	4	5
7. Backs up the team members in their actions	1	2	3	4	5
8. Is slow to accept new ideas	1	2	3	4	5
9. Treats the team members as his or her equal	1	2	3	4	5
10. Is willing to make changes	1	2	3	4	5
11. Is friendly and can be easily approached	1	2	3	4	5
12. Puts suggestions that are made by team members into operation	1	2	3	4	5
13. Gets the approval of the other team members on important matters before going ahead	1	2	3	4	5

Scale Interpretation: Items 3, 4, 5, 6, and 8 are reverse scored — be sure to adjust their value for scoring. Add the values of all 13 items together to arrive at a composite scale score of relationship-oriented leadership style ranging from 13 to 65. Higher values indicate a higher level of relationship-oriented behavior demonstrated by the team leader.

composite team level. Accumulating the responses across members within the same team provides an average team composite score for each scale. This is useful when comparing leader abilities or tracking a leader's development over time. Evaluating individual scale items, particularly the items within the leadership effectiveness scale (Figure 4), helps highlight specific leader strengths and weaknesses.

Feedback to team leaders is a major benefit of using these scales. Leaders gain insight into how well they are satisfying the requirements of sourcing team leadership, as perceived by team members. Individual member responses about a leader must remain confidential to avoid biasing answers. This does not mean, however, that a leader cannot discuss team responses with members to identify

FIGURE 3

ASSESSING TASK-ORIENTED LEADERSHIP BEHAVIOR

Please indicate the appropriate response to each of the following items as they apply to the leader of this cross-functional team.

The leader of our team:	Almost Never	Not Usually	Occasionally	Often	Almost Always
1. Talks about how much should be done	1	2	3	4	5
2. Encourages slow-working team members to greater effort	1	2	3	4	5
3. Assigns team members to particular tasks	1	2	3	4	5
4. Asks for sacrifices from the team members for the good of the entire team	1	2	3	4	5
5. Sees to it that team members work up to their performance potential	1	2	3	4	5
6. Offers new approaches to problems	1	2	3	4	5
7. Insists on being informed about decisions made by the team members	1	2	3	4	5
8. Pushes team members for greater efforts	1	2	3	4	5
9. Emphasizes the meeting of deadlines	1	2	3	4	5
10. Emphasizes the quantity of work	1	2	3	4	5
11. Is concerned that we understand our specific team assignments	1	2	3	4	5

Scale Interpretation: No items are reverse scored. Add the values of all 11 items together to arrive at a composite scale score of task-oriented leadership style ranging from 11-55. Higher values indicate a higher level of task-oriented behavior demonstrated by the team leader.

FIGURE 4

ASSESSING EFFECTIVENESS FOR SATISFYING SPECIFIC RESPONSIBILITIES AND REQUIREMENTS OF TEAM LEADERSHIP

Please rate the effectiveness of your team leader for each of the following items:

	Ineffective		Moderately Effective			Totally Effective	
1. Securing individual member involvement	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
2. Managing internal conflict	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
3. Maintaining team focus and direction	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
4. Securing the resources required to support team activities	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
5. Preventing team domination by a member(s) or function(s)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
6. Dealing with obstacles confronting the team	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
7. Coordinating multiple tasks and managing the status of team assignments	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8. Helping establish specific team goals	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
9. Clarifying and/or helping define each member's role	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
10. Providing performance feedback to members	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

Scale Interpretation: Add the values of all 10 items together to arrive a composite score of leadership effectiveness ranging from 10 to 70. Higher values indicate greater levels of leadership effectiveness. Users can also evaluate the items in this scale individually to identify specific areas of strength or weakness. Also, organizations can weigh individual items differently depending on personal preference.

improvement opportunities. This is a logical part of the feedback process. These scales support a formalized approach for reporting on and improving the leadership capabilities of cross-functional sourcing team leaders. Their primary drawback is that they apply only to current team leaders or individuals with previous team leadership experience. They do not identify the *potential* of individuals who have yet to assume formal leadership responsibilities.

CONCLUSION

A recent book on team leadership confirmed the importance of team leaders.²⁰ The authors noted that years of research and experience with hundreds of companies led them to conclude that:

1. Without specially trained and skillful leaders, teams run a high risk of failing.
2. When asked what they would do differently, most organizations report they should have given much more attention, training, and support to their team leaders.
3. Within days of taking a leadership role, team leaders usually realize they need a new set of skills.
4. Even when shared leadership within the team is the ultimate goal, the team as a whole still reports to someone who, by definition, needs advanced team-leadership skills.
5. Formal team leaders who see themselves as "top sergeants" or as "just team members with a few extra duties" greatly increase the chance of total team failure.

Management should not assume that an individual with leadership *potential* has the necessary leadership skills.²¹ For example, does the leader have experience or training in how to reach consensus decisions? Does the leader understand the responsibilities and requirements of the leadership position? Does the leader understand the sourcing process? Relatively few individuals have the qualifications, experience, or training to immediately assume demanding sourcing team leadership positions. A failure to staff this position with qualified individuals will minimize the performance contribution of the cross-functional sourcing team approach — an organizational approach that most firms are relying on to help them well into the 21st century.

REFERENCES

1. Cross-functional sourcing teams consist of personnel from at least three functional areas brought together to accomplish a purchasing- or materials-related assignment. This includes assignments in which the team must consider purchasing goals or decisions involving supply base management.
2. R.M. Monczka and R. J. Trent, *Purchasing and Sourcing Strategy: Trends and Implications* (Tempe, AZ: Center for Advanced Purchasing Studies, 1995)
3. R. Likert, *New Patterns of Management* (New York: McGraw-Hill, 1961), p. 162.
4. In a previous study of cross-functional sourcing teams by Monczka and Trent, only one out of five team members ranked their leader in the top 10 percent of organizational leaders with whom they were familiar. Furthermore, 70 percent of team leaders received an average leadership effectiveness rating from team members of less than five on a seven point scale. No leader received a totally effective average rating.
5. Likert, op.cit., 1961, p. 170.
6. Ibid., p. 172
7. While the team leadership position is critical to success, there is no one ideal model for structuring that position. Different models or combinations of models include rotating leadership responsibilities, using a formal facilitator to coordinate team activities, selecting a single individual to act as team leader throughout a team's existence, having two formal leaders, allowing team leaders to emerge naturally, or allowing members rather than management to select the leader.
8. For a complete discussion of the statistical relationship between various indicators of team interaction, performance, and leadership, see Monczka and Trent, *Cross-Functional Sourcing Team Effectiveness Research Report* (Tempe, AZ: Center for Advanced Purchasing Studies, 1994)
9. G. Barczak and D Wilemon, "Leadership Differences in New Product Development Teams," *Journal of Product Innovation Management*, vol. 6, no. 4 (December 1989), pp. 259-267.
10. Robert D. Pritchard, et al., "Effects of Group Feedback, Goal Setting, and Incentives on Organizational Productivity," *Journal of Applied Psychology*, vol. 73, no. 2 (1988), pp. 337-358.
11. Relatively few individuals currently commit a full-time effort to cross-functional teams. Most assignment are still part time, which can create conflicts between team participation and continuing job responsibilities.
12. R.M. Stogdill, "Leaders and Their Immediate Groups," *Handbook of Leadership* (New York: Free Press, 1981), p. 481.
13. This research used a modified resource categorization developed by Peters and O'Connor. See L.H. Peters and E.J. O'Connor, "Situation Constraints and Work Outcomes: The Influences of a Frequently Overlooked Construct," *Academy of Management Review*, vol.5, no. 3 (March 1990), pp. 391-397.
14. Robert J. Hershock, Charles D. Cowman, and Douglas Peters, "From Experience Action Teams That Work," *Journal of Product Innovation Management* vol.11 (1994), pp. 95-104.
15. Monczka and Trent op.cit, 1994, p. 23.
16. Pritchard, et al., op. cit., 1988, p. 337.
17. R. M. Stogdill and A.E. Coons, *Leader Behavior: Its Description and Measurement* (Columbus, OH: The Bureau of Business Research at The Ohio State University, 1957)
18. Monczka and Trent, op. cit., 1994
19. For an excellent discussion relating to this topic, see J.E. McGrath, *Groups: Interaction and Performance* (Englewood Cliffs, NJ: Prentice-Hall, 1984)
20. John Zenger II, et al., *Leading Teams: Mastering the New Role* (Homewood, IL: Irwin, 1994) pp. 14-15.
21. Developing effective team leaders requires targeting training to individual needs. Possible areas of potential team leadership training include (1) understanding how and when to use consensus decision-making tools and techniques, (2) group problem-solving techniques, (3) time-management tools, including how to run effective meetings, (4) conflict resolution and communication techniques, (5) project-management tools, (6) the use of critical/creative thinking techniques, (7) how to establish team goals, tasks, roles and accountabilities, (8) how to deliver effective performance feedback, (9) awareness of the overall responsibilities and requirements of team leaders, and (10) on-the-job training with a highly effective team leader.